Will Barrett

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Professional Experience

Fractional CTO, Barrett Ventures, December 2023-Present
Independent consultant focused on technology leadership and strategy.

- Leading teams that successfully deliver products across the Data Analytics, Home Improvement, Government, and Consumer spaces.
- Building nearshore and offshore Product and Engineering teams for multiple companies.
- Performed a multi-month audit of a 30-person Engineering team for a leading consumer brand, leading to Board-level recommendations and improved EBITA multiple in preparation for acquisition.

Chief Technical Officer, Bikehub/Tranzito, January 2023-December 2023
Head of Engineering, Bikehub/Tranzito, June 2022-January 2023
Principal Software Engineer, Bikehub/Tranzito, September 2021-June 2022
A 50-person company executing on multiple government contracts, including a tens-of-millions program to upgrade Los Angeles's bus stops with technology-enabled infrastructure.

- Led the development of CurbCMS, a software application to support the new bus stop program in Los Angeles, including geospatial, monitoring, alerting, and advertising tracking features leveraging AWS, Ruby on Rails, Apache Superset, ElasticSearch, Postgres, Jenkins, and various IoT technologies.
- Responsible for all hardware selection and technology support for multiple government-funded programs, working closely with Electrical Engineers and hardware vendors.

Staff Software Engineer, Preset, September 2019-August 2021
Employee 10 at an Andreesen- and Sequoia-backed startup building a business around the open-source project Apache Superset.

- Managed, led, and grew a Feature Team from 3 Engineers to 7 Engineers across three time zones from US Pacific to EU West.
- Led the development of Software as a Service features in preparation for Preset's General Availability launch, including the sign-up flow, account management, payment systems, and management page for multiple Superset instances.

Staff Software Engineer, Entelo, March 2019-August 2019
Short stint due to an Engineering team and Executive exodus before a merger - joined a 30-person team and left a 6-person team.

- Led a project involving the whole Engineering team that cut total AWS spend by 50% (approximately $500k/year) over two months.
- Won an all-Engineering hackathon for leveraging discarded developer laptops as a Continuous Integration cluster.

Senior Software Engineer II, Change.org, November 2017-December 2018
Engineering Manager II, Change.org, May 2017-November 2017
Engineering Manager I, Change.org, August 2016-May 2017
Senior Software Engineer, Change.org, February 2016-August 2016
The largest petition website in the world, organized as a Benefit Corporation, encountered financial challenges during my tenure.

- Created a system to allow zero-downtime migrations of large MySQL tables, significantly increasing stability and uptime.
- Promoted to lead and manage multiple full-stack feature teams, including one that created the digest email system, a weekly personalized send to 50,000,000 individuals in 18 languages.
- Stepped out of management to work on platform concerns and co-architected a high-volume distributed messaging system in Elixir for the comms platform, replacing Salesforce and saving the company approximately $4MM yearly.

Software Developer, Sqwiggle (sqwiggle.com), Speak (speak.io), April 2014-December 2015

Employee number 8 at a startup attempting to bring WebRTC video as a collaboration tool to market for remote work with chat features similar to Slack's current interface.

- Implemented systems allowing Sqwiggle and Speak to move from a peer-to-peer WebRTC connection to leveraging geo-aware video MCU systems, removing low participant limits on the platforms.
- Acted as the primary Operations Engineer for both platforms, supporting application programs and Video MCU systems in AWS.
- Acted as first-line support for the product, handling customer issues and conversing directly with clients and prospects.

Senior Software Engineer, Rouxbe Video Technologies (rouxbe.com), June 2013-March 2014

- Created a provisioning system for fast scaling with the existing infrastructure.
- Implemented a real-time classroom video integration for distributed course delivery.

Principal Consultant, Tall Green Tree Inc. June 2011-June 2013

- Built the initial MVP of Rentalutions.com, later rebranded to Avail and acquired by Realtor.com
- Assisted in founding Bikeindex.org, a 503c non-profit, currently the most extensive national registry of bicycles assisting in recovering stolen bikes. Since its launch in 2013, the BikeIndex has assisted in the recovery of over $15MM in stolen property.

Advertising Industry Work, August 2008-June 2011

- Cut my teeth as a programmer on the "Got Milk? Campaign" in 2008 at Weber Shandwick as an intern.
- Worked on web projects for clients including McDonald's, Jim Beam, and Armor Eckrich at Schafer Condon Carter in Chicago.

Thought Leadership & Industry Service

Contributor/PMC Member, Apache Superset, March 2020-Present

Apache Superset is an open-source business analytics web application that sits on top of organizations' existing data warehouses.

- Developed and implemented coding standards for the project.
- Led the development of Alerts and Reports in Superset, Preset's most-requested feature during our Private Beta.

Education

B.Mus. Cello Performance, Peabody Institute of Music at the Johns Hopkins University, 2007

Studied classical Cello performance under Alan Stepansky, former principal cellist of the New York Philharmonic.